

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

WEDNESDAY, 30 SEPTEMBER 2026

16 must-know stories, 17 Prelims facts, 22 editorials and 16 explainers, picked from 992 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Curative petition filed over SC's ruling in CEC, EC's appointment law

A curative petition has been filed in the Supreme Court seeking the recall of an order referring challenges against the CEC and EC appointment law to a Constitution bench. The petition was filed by Congress leader Jaya Thakur, who is one of the petitioners challenging the CEC and ECs Act of 2023. The petitioner cited a reasonable apprehension of bias regarding one of the judges who decided the case, Justice Satish Chandra Sharma. On September 23, Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma delivered a split verdict and placed the matter before the Chief Justice of India to form a five-judge bench. The plea for recall is based on reports that Justice Sharma's son appears as counsel for the Election Commission of India before the Madhya Pradesh High Court. The petition notes that this familial connection was unknown to the petitioners during the prior hearings on the challenge. A curative petition represents the final judicial recourse available under Indian law to overturn a judgment of the Supreme Court. The underlying legal challenges question the constitutional validity of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners Act, 2023.

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Jaya Thakur, Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, Justice Dipankar Datta, Chief Justice of India ·

Prelims: Jaya Thakur filed the curative petition in the Supreme Court.; The split verdict was delivered by Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma on September 23.; The law in question is the CEC & ECs (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023.

Why it matters — Tests the procedural application and grounds for entertaining curative petitions in high-stakes constitutional matters.; Brings the integrity, transparency, and independence of judicial decision-making and institutional appointments into sharp focus.

Static — A curative petition is the final constitutional and judicial review mechanism in the Supreme Court, entertained only after a review petition is dismissed. The concept of curative petitions was evolved by the Supreme Court in the landmark 2002 case of Rupa Ashok Hurra vs. Ashok Hurra to prevent abuse of process and miscarriage of justice. Article 145 of the Constitution empowers the Supreme Court to frame rules for its practice and procedure, which governs the filing of curative petitions.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Appointment

[Hindustan Times: read the source](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

The Union Public Service Commission completes one hundred years of its institutional journey on October 1 2026. The Commission evolved from an advisory body set up in 1926 into an independent constitutional body. Entry into public service shifted from East India Company patronage to open competition through the Indian Civil Service examination instituted in 1855. Early examinations were held only in London and tested subjects like Greek and Latin, making it extremely difficult for Indians. Satyendranath Tagore became the first Indian to clear the ICS examination in 1863 and joined the service in 1864. Sustained nationalist demands under the Government of India Act 1919 led to the provision for a Public Service Commission. India's first Public Service Commission was constituted on October 1 1926. The ICS examination was held in India for the first time in 1922 at Allahabad alongside London before moving to Delhi in 1928.

When: 1855, 1863, 1922, 1924, 1 October 1926 · **Where:** London, Allahabad, Delhi, India · **Who:** Satyendranath Tagore, Lee Commission ·

Prelims: The first Public Service Commission was constituted on October 1 1926.; The Indian Civil Service examination was instituted in London in 1855.; Satyendranath Tagore cleared the ICS examination in 1863 as the first Indian.

Why it matters — Highlights the historical struggle of Indians in accessing the elite civil services during British rule.; Marks the centenary of India's premier recruitment agency responsible for merit-based selections.

Static — The Union Public Service Commission is an independent constitutional body established under Article 315 of the Constitution of India. It conducts examinations for appointments to the all-India services and central services Group A and Group B. The Chairman and other members

of the UPSC are appointed by the President of India.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy

[PIB: read the source](#) · [free copy on ndtv.com](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Allows Appeal of Employees Against Union of India in Reservation Matter — Sets Aside Madras State Administrative Tribunal Order Upholding Lower Qualifying Marks for SC/ST in Promotions. Constitution Bench Declares That Providing Lower

The Supreme Court delivered this verdict on an appeal challenging lower qualifying marks for reserved categories in promotions. The Supreme Court allowed an employee appeal against the Union of India and set aside a Madras State Administrative Tribunal order that upheld lower qualifying marks for SC/ST candidates in promotions.

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** Madras · **Who:** Supreme Court, Union of India, Madras State Administrative Tribunal · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court allowed the appeal of employees against the Union of India.; The order set aside was passed by the Madras State Administrative Tribunal.; The matter involved lower qualifying marks for SC/ST in promotions.

Why it matters — *It clarifies the legal standards required for implementing reservation policies in public employment promotions.; It reinforces the constitutional balance between social justice and administrative efficiency under Article 335.*

Static — Article 335 of the Constitution of India mandates that the claims of members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes shall be taken into consideration consistently with the maintenance of efficiency of administration. Reservation in promotions for SC and ST employees has evolved through landmark judgments including Indra Sawhney, M. Nagaraj, and Jarnail Singh cases. The M. Nagaraj (2006) judgment laid down prerequisites for reservation in promotions, requiring the state to collect quantifiable data showing backwardness and inadequacy of representation.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Judgment

[Lawtext: read the source](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

UAPA: Can Prosecution Sanction Delay Justify Extension To File Charge Sheet? Supreme Court Clarifies

The issue reached the Supreme Court for an authoritative clarification on statutory time limits and sanction delays under anti-terror laws. The Supreme Court clarified whether delays in obtaining prosecution sanction under the UAPA can serve as a valid ground for extending the time to file a charge sheet.

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court · **Prelims:** The statute in question is the Unlawful Activities Prevention Act (UAPA).; The case involves the rules surrounding prosecution sanction delays and charge sheet extensions.

Why it matters — *It strengthens procedural safeguards against prolonged incarceration without a charge sheet.; It checks administrative delays by the government in granting prosecution sanctions.*

Static — The Unlawful Activities Prevention Act was enacted in 1967 to provide for more effective prevention of certain unlawful activities of individuals and associations. UAPA grants broad powers to the central government to designate terrorist organizations and individuals. Section 43D of the UAPA modifies the Code of Criminal Procedure to extend the default period for filing a charge sheet and detaining an accused.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Internal Security · Prelims angle: Judgment

[LawBeat: read the source](#)

Governance & Policy

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves extension of Jal Jeevan Mission till December 2028; outlay raised to Rs 8.69 lakh crore

The Union Cabinet approved the extension of the Jal Jeevan Mission until December 2028 along with a restructured implementation strategy for rural drinking water supply. The extension was triggered by the need to shift from a primarily infrastructure-driven initiative to a citizen-centric utility model ensuring sustainable long-term service delivery. The core issue is ensuring sustainable piped potable water supply and long-term operation and maintenance of water systems across all rural households. The total financial outlay for the mission has been increased to Rs 8.69 lakh crore, featuring a central assistance of Rs 3.59 lakh crore representing an additional central share of Rs 1.51 lakh crore. The government will introduce a national digital framework named Sujalam Bharat to assign each village a unique Sujal Gaon or Service Area ID to map the water supply chain. Community participation will be strengthened through initiatives like Jal Arpan, allowing Gram Panchayats and Village Water and Sanitation Committees to formally participate in commissioning schemes. An annual community-led event called Jal Utsav will be introduced to review and maintain local water infrastructure and promote collective responsibility.

When: December 2028 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Ministry of Jal Shakti, Prime Minister Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** The total outlay for the Jal Jeevan Mission has been increased to Rs 8.69 lakh crore.; Central assistance for the mission has been raised to Rs 3.59 lakh crore.; As of government data cited, 15.80 crore out of 19.36 crore rural households have tap water connections.

Why it matters — *Substantially expands financial allocation and central assistance to complete rural water infrastructure electrification and connection goals.; Integrates digital monitoring via Sujalam Bharat to enhance transparency, accountability,*

and end-to-end supply chain tracking.

Static — Jal Jeevan Mission is a flagship central scheme implemented by the Ministry of Jal Shakti to provide safe and adequate drinking water through individual household tap connections to all rural households. The mission was launched in 2019-20 with an initial emphasis on building rapid physical infrastructure to connect rural homes with piped water. The scheme works on the principle of local community management, encouraging the formation of Village Water and Sanitation Committees to plan, implement, and manage local water sources.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy, Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

[ddnews.gov.in: read the source](#) · also reported by PIB, Economic Times

International Relations

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

India joins WTO Fisheries Subsidies Agreement, backs sustainable fishing and small-scale fishers

India has formally become a party to the WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies by depositing its Instrument of Acceptance. The Instrument of Acceptance was handed over by the Commerce Secretary to the WTO Director-General on Monday. India has become the 123rd WTO member to join the Agreement, which was adopted by consensus during the 12th Ministerial Conference in Geneva in June 2022. The Agreement entered into force on September 15, 2025, after securing acceptance from two-thirds of WTO members. The pact targets marine wild capture fishing and related activities while explicitly excluding aquaculture and inland fisheries. The Agreement aims to curb subsidies contributing to illegal, unreported and unregulated fishing and fishing of overexploited stocks. India's aquaculture sector, including shrimp exports, remains unaffected as it is outside the scope of the Agreement. The move is expected to discipline harmful subsidies supporting large industrial fleets of distant-water fishing nations and protect traditional fishers. India's existing frameworks like the Sustainable Harnessing of Fisheries in the Exclusive Economic Zone Rules 2025 align with the Agreement.

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** Geneva · **Who:** Commerce Secretary, WTO Director-General · **Prelims:** India is the 123rd WTO member to join the Agreement.; The Agreement was adopted during the WTO's 12th Ministerial Conference in Geneva in June 2022.; The Agreement entered into force on September 15, 2025.

Why it matters — Protects the livelihoods of traditional and small-scale Indian fishers by curbing distant-water industrial subsidies.; Strengthens India's reputation as a responsible seafood exporter without impacting its aquaculture-driven shrimp exports.

Static — The World Trade Organization (WTO) is the sole global international organization dealing with the rules of trade between nations, established in 1995. The WTO Ministerial Conference is the top decision-making body of the organization, which usually meets once every two years. Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) is an area of the sea stretching up to 200 nautical miles from the coast within which a state has special rights.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

[ddnews.gov.in: read the source](#)

Health

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

Govt launches haemophilia scheme, sets aside Rs 26 crore

The state health department approved the Mukhyamantri Haemophilia Yojana to provide advanced treatment for the blood disorder. The government has sanctioned Rs 26.33 crore for the first year of the newly launched scheme. The core issue addressed is the high cost of advanced non-factor drugs like Emicizumab, which places a heavy financial burden on patients. The scheme will procure Emicizumab and make it accessible to patients across the state. Implementation of the scheme will be carried out through the Mukhyamantri Chikitsa Sahayata Kosh. Health minister Nishant Kumar stated that improving access to haemophilia treatment is a priority for the department. The initiative aims to reduce out-of-pocket expenditure and ensure timely medical care for economically weaker families. This step is expected to expand specialized healthcare access in Bihar and improve treatment outcomes for patients.

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** Patna, Bihar · **Who:** State health department, Health Minister Nishant Kumar · **Prelims:** Scheme Name: Mukhyamantri Haemophilia Yojana; Allocated Budget: Rs 26.33 crore for the first year; Drug to be procured: Emicizumab

Why it matters — Reduces catastrophic out-of-pocket health expenditure for economically weaker families managing lifelong chronic illnesses.; Ensures regular and timely availability of modern, high-cost non-factor therapies like Emicizumab through government channels.

Static — Haemophilia is a rare, inherited genetic disorder where the blood does not clot properly due to a lack of sufficient blood-clotting proteins. Type A and Type B are the most common forms of haemophilia, caused by deficiencies in clotting factor VIII and factor IX respectively. Treatment traditionally involves replacement therapy, which entails infusing the specific clotting factor concentrates into a vein.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

[timesofindia.indiatimes.com: read the source](#)

Economy

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Draft Petroleum (Amendment) Bill, 2026 Released for Stakeholder and Public Consultation

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas released the draft Petroleum (Amendment) Bill, 2026 for public and stakeholder consultation. The draft legislation was hosted on the ministry website along with an explanatory note providing a brief overview of the proposed amendments. This initiative forms part of the government's pre-legislative consultation process to gather inputs from industry participants and citizens. Stakeholders and members of the public have been invited to submit their comments and suggestions on the proposed legislation. The deadline for sending feedback and comments on the draft Bill is October 30, 2026. Submissions can be sent by mail to the Under Secretary (Distribution) at Kartavya Bhawan-03, New Delhi, or via designated email addresses. The ministry stated that all inputs and suggestions received during this consultation process will be duly examined before proceeding further.

When: September 30, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas · **Prelims:** The draft legislation released is the Petroleum (Amendment) Bill, 2026.; The deadline for submitting comments and suggestions is October 30, 2026.; Submissions can be sent to the Under Secretary (Distribution) at Kartavya Bhawan-03, New Delhi-110001.

Why it matters — Promotes participatory governance and transparency in drafting energy sector laws in India.; Allows industry players and the public to voice concerns on proposed regulatory changes for petroleum distribution and safety.

Static — Pre-legislative consultation policy in India requires ministries to place draft legislations in the public domain for a specified period to ensure transparency and participatory governance. The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas is charged with the exploration, production, refining, distribution, marketing, import, export, and conservation of petroleum and petroleum products in India. Legislative amendments in India typically go through stakeholder consultations, inter-ministerial evaluations, cabinet approvals, and subsequent introduction in Parliament as Bills.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution, Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

[PIB: read the source](#) · [free copy on msn.com](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

NEW CORPORATE AVERAGE FUEL ECONOMY (CAFE) NORMS NOTIFIED

The Ministry of Power has notified the new Corporate Average Fuel Economy (CAFE-3) norms for passenger vehicles, effective from April 2027 to March 2032. The new rules remove a separate concession proposed earlier for small petrol cars weighing up to 909 kg following opposition from leading automakers. The core issue involves balancing fleet-wide carbon dioxide emission targets while promoting cleaner technologies through a revised weight-adjustment formula and credit mechanism. The reference vehicle weight has been increased from 1,082 kg under existing norms to 1,229 kg under the final rules, providing more relief to lighter vehicles. The fuel-consumption benchmark is tightened from 3.996 litres per 100 km in 2027-28 to 3.3273 litres per 100 km in 2031-32, marking a 16.7 percent improvement. The framework includes a super-credit system where one battery electric or range-extended electric vehicle is counted as three vehicles. Strong hybrids running on flex-fuel get a 2.5x factor, strong hybrids get 1.6x, and flex-fuel vehicles get a 1.1x factor. A credit-debit system is introduced, allowing manufacturers performing better than emissions targets to earn credits and others to accumulate debits.

When: April 2027 to March 2032 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Power · **Prelims:** CAFE-3 norms will remain in force from April 2027 to March 2032.; The reference vehicle weight under the new norms is 1,229 kg.; Battery electric vehicles receive a 3x multiplier factor under the super-credit mechanism.

Why it matters — Drives progressive improvements in fuel economy with a 16.7 percent tightening of consumption benchmarks by 2032.; Encourages fleet electrification and alternative fuel adoption through a multi-tier super-credit multiplier system.

Static — Corporate Average Fuel Economy (CAFE) norms regulate the average fuel efficiency of a manufacturer's total fleet of vehicles sold in a country. CAFE norms are designed to lower fuel consumption and reduce carbon dioxide emissions from passenger vehicles in line with national climate goals. India first introduced CAFE regulations in 2017, aligning them with BS-VI emission standards to progressively push automakers toward fuel efficiency.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

[PIB: read the source](#) · [free copy on lokmatimes.com](#) · also reported by ForumIAS, CNBC TV18, Fortune India, The Hindu, Telangana Today, ABP Live English, urbanacres.in, Livemint, National Herald

GS3

MAKE NOTES

India's fiscal deficit widens to Rs. 7.1 lakh crore, hits 41.9% of FY27 target by August

India's fiscal deficit stood at Rs. 7.10 lakh crore, reaching 41.9% of the full-year target by the end of August. The fiscal deficit was higher than the 38.1% of the Budget Estimates recorded during the corresponding period last year. The Centre has set a full-year fiscal deficit target of 4.3% of GDP, translating to Rs. 16.96 lakh crore for 2026-27. The Centre's net tax revenue reached around Rs. 8.38 lakh crore during the April-August period, which is 29.2% of the budget estimate. Total government expenditure during the first five months of the fiscal hit Rs. 20.78 lakh crore, accounting for 38.9% of the budget estimates. Total receipts amounted to Rs. 13.68 lakh crore, aligning at 37.5% of the total budget. Major government subsidies rose to Rs. 1.87 lakh crore amidst ongoing fiscal challenges.

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Controller General of Accounts (CGA) · **Prelims:** Fiscal deficit stood at Rs. 7,10,249 crore during April-August of 2026-27.; Fiscal deficit hit 41.9% of the FY27 target by the end of August.; Net tax revenue stood at around Rs. 8.38 lakh crore,

accounting for 29.2% of the corresponding BE.

Why it matters — Serves as a key indicator of government borrowing requirements and macroeconomic stability.; Helps monitor tax collection efficiency and public expenditure trends during the fiscal year.

Static — Fiscal deficit is the gap between the government's total expenditure and its total receipts, excluding borrowings. The Controller General of Accounts (CGA) compiles and releases monthly and annual accounts of the Union Government. The Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) Act mandates fiscal discipline and targets to reduce fiscal deficit.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

[Economic Times: read the source](#) · [free copy on msn.com](#)

Agriculture & Allied

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for Rabi Crops for Marketing Season 2027-28

The Union Cabinet approved the Minimum Support Price policy for six Rabi crops for the Rabi Marketing Season 2027-28. The decision aims to ensure remunerative prices to growers for their produce and covers 324 metric tonnes of procurement. The policy involves an estimated payout of Rs 90,962 crore to farmers across the country. The absolute highest increase in MSP was announced for Safflower at Rs 675 per quintal, followed by Rapeseed and Mustard at Rs 413 per quintal. Increases for other crops include Rs 390 for lentil, Rs 136 for barley, Rs 83 for gram, and Rs 25 for wheat per quintal. Revised MSP for wheat is set at Rs 2,610 per quintal and barley at Rs 2,286 per quintal. Pulse and oilseed support prices include gram at Rs 5,958, lentil at Rs 7,390, rapeseed and mustard at Rs 6,613, and safflower at Rs 7,215 per quintal. The revised prices guarantee a margin of at least 50% over the projected all-India weighted average cost of production.

When: 2027-28 Marketing Season · **Where:** India · **Who:** Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) · **Prelims:** Wheat MSP for RMS 2027-28 has been set at Rs 2,610 per quintal.; Safflower received the absolute highest MSP increase at Rs 675 per quintal.; The expected return over cost of production is highest for wheat at 106 percent.

Why it matters — Provides financial certainty and remunerative returns to farmers across 324 metric tonnes of procurement with an estimated payout of Rs 90,962 crore.; Maintains a margin of at least 50 percent over the cost of production, fulfilling the Union Budget 2018-19 mandate.

Static — Minimum Support Price (MSP) is a form of market intervention by the Government of India to insure agricultural producers against any sharp fall in farm prices. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) takes the final decision on fixing MSPs based on recommendations of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP). CACP recommends MSPs after evaluating production costs, inter-crop price parity, supply-demand dynamics, domestic and global market prices, and agricultural terms of trade.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy

[PIB: read the source](#) · [free copy on cnbctv18.com](#) · also reported by [Economic Times](#), [Business Standard](#), [BusinessLine](#), [Mint](#), [Upstox](#), [Hindustan Times](#), [Zee Business](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Centre approves Rs. 5,547.99 crore procurement at MSP for pulses, oilseeds in three states

The Centre approved procurement worth Rs. 5,547.99 crore at Minimum Support Price under the Price Support Scheme for major pulses and oilseeds. The decision covers Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, and Telangana for the Kharif Marketing Season 2026-27. The Agriculture Ministry stated the measure protects farmers from falling market prices and ensures remunerative returns. Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan highlighted the government's commitment to farmer welfare and agricultural self-reliance. Uttar Pradesh received the largest share with procurement worth Rs. 3,992.57 crore, including tur and moong. Karnataka received approval for procurement worth Rs. 1,107 crore, covering soybean, moong, and sunflower. Telangana received approval for procurement worth Rs. 448.42 crore, covering soybean and moong. Farmers will receive payments for their produce directly into their bank accounts in a time-bound manner through transparent arrangements.

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, Telangana · **Who:** Union Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan · **Prelims:** Total approved procurement amount: Rs. 5,547.99 crore.; States included: Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, and Telangana.; Season: Kharif Marketing Season 2026-27.

Why it matters — Provides vital economic security to farmers against price volatility during the Kharif season.; Aids India's self-reliance in pulses and edible oils by incentivizing domestic cultivation.

Static — The Minimum Support Price is an agricultural product price set by the government to purchase directly from farmers, insuring them against sharp price falls. The Price Support Scheme is implemented for the procurement of notified pulses, oilseeds, and copra on a 'no-loss, no-profit' basis by central nodal agencies in collaboration with state governments. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends the MSPs for various crops to the central government.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

[newsonair.gov.in: read the source](#) · also reported by [PIB](#), [BusinessLine](#), [The Hindu](#)

Infrastructure & Energy

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Green Energy Corridor Phase-III scheme for Development of Intra-State Transmission System with Battery Energy Storage Systems

The Union Cabinet approved the Green Energy Corridor Phase-III scheme to develop an intra-state transmission system with battery storage. The initiative aims to evacuate up to 135 gigawatts of renewable energy across states and union territories. The core objective is to address renewable energy intermittency, grid congestion, peak-hour curtailment, and non-solar hour demand. The project has a total outlay of Rs 1,86,405 crore, targeted for completion by financial year 2032-33. The outlay comprises Rs 1,36,378 crore for intra-state transmission systems and Rs 50,000 crore for 50 gigawatt-hours of battery energy storage systems. The scheme involves a total central financial support of Rs 54,082 crore to offset transmission charges and keep power costs down. Greenfield projects under the intra-state transmission component will be implemented via Tariff Based Competitive Bidding on a Build-Own-Operate-Maintain model. Brownfield upgradation and network strengthening works will be executed under a Cost Plus Basis, with State Transmission Utilities acting as overall implementing agencies. The scheme contributes to long-term energy security, helps achieve 900 GW installed non-fossil capacity by 2035, and generates employment.

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, State Transmission Utilities, Transmission Service Providers · **Prelims:** Total project outlay for Green Energy Corridor Phase-III is Rs 1,86,405 crore.; The scheme targets the deployment of 50 GWh of Battery Energy Storage Systems.; Total central financial support under the scheme is Rs 54,082 crore.

Why it matters — *Crucial for evacuating 135 GW of renewable energy across various states and union territories.; Reduces power costs for end consumers by offsetting intra-state transmission charges through central financial assistance.*

Static — Green Energy Corridor (GEC) schemes are designed to synchronize electricity produced from renewable sources with conventional power grids. Intra-State Transmission Systems (InSTS) handle the evacuation of power from generation sites to distribution networks within state boundaries. Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) store electrical energy to balance supply and demand fluctuations caused by the intermittent nature of solar and wind power.

Syllabus: GS3: Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy, Economy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

PIB: [read the source](#) · [free copy on tribuneindia.com](#) · also reported by DD News, The Economic Times, The Hindu, zeebiz.com, Livemint

Environment & Ecology

GS3

MAKE NOTES

National Coastal Mission 2.0

Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav launched the implementation guidelines for the National Coastal Mission 2.0 on Wednesday in New Delhi. The new guidelines aim to promote a whole-of-government approach, streamline processes, clarify institutional responsibilities, and strengthen monitoring. NCM 2.0 will subsume its predecessor, NCM 1.0, which was implemented from 2021-22 to 2025-26. The mission has an approved financial outlay of Rs 767 crore and will run for the period from 2025-26 to 2030-31. NCM 1.0 supported mangrove and coral reef conservation, R&D in marine ecosystems, and sustainable beach development. NCM 2.0 provides a comprehensive framework to strengthen coastal resilience through vulnerability assessments, ecosystem restoration, and pollution management. Activities under the mission will be executed across all coastal states and Union territories to cover diverse coastal and marine ecosystems.

When: 2025-26 to 2030-31 · **Where:** New Delhi and coastal states/UTs of India · **Who:** Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav ·

Prelims: Financial outlay of NCM 2.0: Rs 767 crore; Implementation period of NCM 2.0: 2025-26 to 2030-31; Implementation period of NCM 1.0: 2021-22 to 2025-26

Why it matters — *Enhances coastal resilience against climate change impacts and extreme weather events through vulnerability assessments.; Promotes sustainable management of blue economy assets, balancing conservation with economic activities like sustainable tourism.*

Static — India has a vast coastline of over 7,500 km, supporting densely populated coastal regions and rich biodiversity like mangroves and coral reefs. Mangroves act as natural bio-shields against cyclones, storm surges, and coastal erosion while supporting coastal livelihoods. Coral reefs are vital marine ecosystems that protect coastlines and harbor diverse marine flora and fauna.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

Vajiram & Ravi: [read the source](#) · [free copy on theprint.in](#) · also reported by PIB, DD India

GS1 GS3

MAKE NOTES

Southwest monsoon ends with 12% deficit

India's 2026 southwest monsoon concluded with 759.4 mm of rainfall, which is 12.6 percent below the normal level of 868.6 mm. This recorded precipitation marks the lowest rainfall during the monsoon season since the year 2015. The east and northeast region experienced its driest monsoon since 1901, recording 1,017.1 mm of rainfall. The southern peninsula witnessed its fourth lowest rainfall level since 1901 during the season. The India Meteorological Department reported that October is expected to be hotter and drier than usual across most parts of the country. The southwest monsoon is driven by seasonal wind reversals caused by differential heating and pressure differences between land and sea. Agriculture and rural livelihoods in India depend heavily on timely and adequately distributed rainfall from the southwest monsoon.

When: 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** India Meteorological Department · **Prelims:** India received 759.4 mm of rain during the 2026 southwest monsoon.; The 2026 monsoon recorded a 12.6 percent deficit compared to the normal 868.6 mm.; The east and northeast region recorded its driest monsoon since 1901 with 1,017.1 mm of rainfall.

Why it matters — A deficient monsoon impacts agricultural production, rural earnings, consumption, and overall national GDP growth.; Regional disparities like the historic dryness in the east and northeast pose localized agrarian challenges.

Static — The southwest monsoon typically starts in early June, bringing moisture-laden winds from the Indian Ocean, and begins its retreat in October. El Niño involves the periodic warming of sea surface temperatures in the central and equatorial Pacific Ocean, weakening trade winds and suppressing monsoons. The Madden-Julian Oscillation is an eastward-moving system of winds, clouds, and pressure that circles the globe every 30 to 60 days.

Syllabus: GS1 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, Geography

[The Hindu: read the source](#) · [free copy on nextias.com](#) · also reported by *Economic Times*, *Down To Earth*

Science & Technology

GS3

MAKE NOTES

New Discovery Track for Startups and MSMEs with Financial Assistance upto Rs. 50 cr under PRIP Scheme announced

It was announced to address critical early-stage funding gaps and encourage startups and MSMEs to enter the high-risk drug discovery ecosystem. The Department of Pharmaceuticals launched a New Discovery track under the PRIP Scheme, offering financial assistance of up to Rs. 50 crore to startups and MSMEs for early-stage novel drug discovery. In order to encourage discovery, development and commercialisation of new medicines and to support Start-ups and MSMEs, the Department of Pharmaceuticals, has announced a New Discovery track under the Promotion of Research and Innovation in Pharma & MedTech (PRIP) Scheme for undertaking Pharma Innovation projects. The objective is to encourage and enable start-ups and MSMEs to venture in to high-risk innovation ecosystem for discovery of new drugs and therapies. This new track seeks to address a critical funding gap in early-stage novel drug discovery. Financial assistance of up to Rs. 50 crore per company/project/portfolio of projects will be provided, subject to a minimum co-funding of 25% of

When: 2026-09-30 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Department of Pharmaceuticals · **Prelims:** Maximum financial assistance is up to Rs. 50 crore per company/project.; Minimum co-funding required is 25% of the project cost from bona fide institutional investors.; Eligible projects include NCE/NBE projects at Technology Readiness Levels 1, 2, or 3.

Why it matters — Helps build a globally competitive domestic drug innovation pipeline for India.; Catalyses institutional investor participation in early-stage drug development.

Static — The Department of Pharmaceuticals functions under the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers, Government of India, promoting the development of the pharmaceutical sector. Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) are defined based on investment and turnover criteria under the MSME Development Act to drive industrial growth. Technology Readiness Levels (TRLs) are a method used to estimate the maturity of technologies during the acquisition phase of a program.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

[PIB: read the source](#)

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

QUICK READ

Cabinet approves Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS) for Delhi

The Cabinet approved Rs 1,789.52 crore for an Intelligent Traffic Management System in Delhi, to be implemented by the Delhi Police. The project covers 42 traffic corridors and aims to manage traffic using real-time road conditions rather than fixed signal timings. Delhi has around 71 lakh active registered vehicles, which has placed increasing pressure on the existing road network.

[The Hindu: source](#)

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

ICAR and FCI signs MoU for Safe and Sustainable Foodgrain Storage

An MoU was signed between ICAR and FCI on 30 September 2026 to address severe pest resistance and safety risks of traditional chemicals. The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) and the Food Corporation of India (FCI) signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on 30 September 2026 to undertake research on alternative fumigation technologies for safe and sustainable management of storage pests in wheat and rice.

[PIB: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

QUICK READ

Election Commission of India extends the SIR dates in Andhra Pradesh and Meghalaya

The Election Commission of India extended the timeline for the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls in Andhra Pradesh and Meghalaya. The decision was finalized at a full Commission meeting on Wednesday, September 30, 2026, led by Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and Commissioners SS Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.

[NDTV: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

Bankers Books Evidence Act, 2026

The Bankers Books Evidence Act, 2026 comes into force on October 1, 2026, replacing the colonial-era Bankers Books Evidence Act, 1891. The legislation modernises India's legal framework by introducing a technology-neutral approach covering physical, electronic, and digital banking records. The Act applies to court proceedings, arbitrations, investigations, and inquiries under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, or other laws.

[PIB: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

Odisha Assembly Passes Jan Vishwas and Indian Stamp Amendment Bills

The Odisha Legislative Assembly passed the Odisha Jan Vishwas Bill, 2026 and the Indian Stamp (Odisha Amendment) Bill, 2026 during its Monsoon Session. The legislation aims to reduce regulatory burdens, rationalise penalties, and simplify stamp duty and registration procedures in the state. The Odisha Jan Vishwas Bill, 2026 aims to ease regulatory compliance by decriminalising minor offences and simplifying approval processes.

[drishtias.com: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

EXERCISE

QUICK READ

ASEAN-INDIA MARITIME EXERCISE (AIME-2026) COMMENCES IN SUBIC BAY, PHILIPPINES

The second edition of the ASEAN-India Maritime Exercise (AIME-2026) commenced at Subic Bay, Philippines, on 28 September 2026. The exercise is conducted under the theme “Anchored in Trust, United at Sea” to enhance interoperability and maritime cooperation. Indian Naval Ships Sahyadri and Kulish are participating alongside regional assets like BRP Jose Rizal, BRP Tarlac, and RSS Justice.

[PIB: source](#)

ECONOMY

JUDGMENT

QUICK READ

SC reserves verdict on CoC's power to withdraw approved resolution plan

The matter reached the Supreme Court for legal adjudication regarding the extent of powers held by the Committee of Creditors under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code. The Supreme Court has reserved its judgment on whether the Committee of Creditors can withdraw a resolution plan that has already been approved.

[Business Standard: source](#)

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE

QUICK READ

India's new Sites in UNESCO Tentative List – Bagh Cave Paintings and Group of Temples of the Chambal Valley

India's UNESCO Tentative List has expanded to 78 sites following five new additions, which include the Bagh Cave Paintings and the Group of Temples of the Chambal Valley. The additions highlight India's rich cultural heritage, ancient rock-cut architecture, and medieval temple styles spanning different dynasties and historical periods. The core issue involves preserving and globally recognizing India's diverse historical monuments through official UNESCO listings.

[ForumIAS: source](#)

GOVERNANCE & POLICY

QUICK READ

Digital India BHASHINI Division and CAG Launch “CAG-BHASHINI Anuvaad” to Enable AI-powered Multilingual Translation of Official Documents

The Digital India BHASHINI Division and the Office of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India launched "CAG-BHASHINI Anuvaad". The AI-enabled document translation solution was launched during the closing ceremony of the 74th Hindi Diwas and Hindi Pakhwada 2026 in New Delhi. The initiative brings multilingual Language AI into institutional workflows while retaining human oversight for official translation processes.

[PIB: source](#)

ECONOMY

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

Release of the Annual Survey of Industries (2024-25) results

Total industrial employment crossed 2 crore in 2024-25, rising from 1.96 crore in 2023-24 to 2.10 crore, a growth of 7.19 per cent driven mainly by manufacturing. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released the Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) 2024-25 factsheet based on fieldwork conducted from October 2025 to June 2026.

[PIB: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

Delhi Records Lowest September Average AQI in Five Years; Air Quality Improvement Trend Continues in 2026

Delhi recorded a monthly average Air Quality Index (AQI) of 102 in September 2026, the lowest for the month in five years. The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change announced that the overall air quality improvement trend continued through 2026. The core issue is managing and abating air pollution in Delhi-NCR, especially ahead of the vulnerable winter season.

[PIB: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

SPECIES

PLACE IN NEWS

QUICK READ

New toad species described in northeast mountain tops

A May 2026 study formally described and published the finding of this new toad species. A newly described toad species, *Duttaphrynus phawngpui* sp. nov.) from Phawngpui National Park, located in southeastern Mizoram along the border with Myanmar. Researchers studied two individuals found at the hilltops. The species was named after Phawngpui, Mizoram's highest mountain peak at 2,157 metres above sea level.

[Mongabay India: source](#)

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED

SCHEME

QUICK READ

Over Rs 1,200 Crore Allocated to 10 states under PM-RKVY Agriculture Scheme, 'Khet Bachao Abhiyan' Launched; Check Beneficiary States

The Centre has sanctioned more than Rs 1,200 crore to 10 states under the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (PM-RKVY). The announcements were made by Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan during the National Agriculture Conference-Rabi Campaign 2026. West Bengal received the highest allocation with Rs 290 crore, followed by Haryana with Rs 198 crore and Chhattisgarh with Rs 181 crore.

[jagranjosh.com: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

SPECIES

PLACE IN NEWS

QUICK READ

Tigress from Bihar's Valmiki Tiger Reserve to be introduced at Bengal's Buxa on Oct 2

A three-year-old tigress was flown from Bihar's Valmiki Tiger Reserve to West Bengal's Buxa Tiger Reserve on Wednesday. The transfer marks West Bengal's first tiger reintroduction, following a 2018 NTCA report stating Buxa had no tigers. Authorities planned this reintroduction over eight years by restoring the reserve's habitat, prey base, and relocating villages.

[Hindustan Times: source](#)

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED

SCHEME

QUICK READ

Maharashtra Government unveils Fodder Development Policy to tackle shortage

The Maharashtra Cabinet approved a statewide fodder development policy to ensure adequate fodder availability for livestock across the state. The policy focuses on district-wise fodder production, identifying cultivable grasses and fodder trees, promoting improved fodder crops, and using traditional and non-traditional sources. The Cabinet approved a 10 per cent parallel reservation for ex-servicemen in state government Group-C recruitment, including those leaving service after four years.

[The Hindu: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

QUICK READ

Saudi-India BIPA: 5 key takeaways for global investors as Cabinet approves deal

The Union Cabinet approved the India-Saudi Arabia Bilateral Investment Protection Agreement to protect and facilitate mutual investments. The treaty provides greater legal certainty, non-discriminatory treatment, and confidence for cross-border investors from both nations. Saudi Arabia is India's fourth largest trade partner, and India is Saudi Arabia's second largest trade partner. Bilateral trade between India and Saudi Arabia reached \$41.88 billion in the 2024-25 period.

[zeebiz.com: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

India rejects Australia's WTO counter-notification on sugar market price support

Australia filed a counter-notification at the WTO questioning India's domestic support policies for sugar. India rejected Australia's WTO counter-notification challenging its market price support mechanisms for sugar.

[ChiniMandi: source](#)

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 India's liquidity upswell: What should the central bank's monetary policy committee do?

An upcoming policy meeting has put the spotlight on whether the central bank will act to address India's liquidity upswell. The Reserve Bank of India and its monetary policy committee are confronting a major surge in banking system liquidity that threatens near-term macroeconomic stability. As a policy meeting looms, a surge in liquidity should have the central bank anxious about its near-term effects.

[Mint](#)

GS2 The imbalance in a split judgment

A two-judge bench of the Supreme Court delivered a split verdict regarding the constitutional issues surrounding appointments to the Election Commission. Justice S C Sharma noted that the constitutional issues involved deserved consideration by a larger bench. The split verdict prevents the Court from defending its earlier constitutional bench judgment in the Baranwal case. The judges stated they wanted to avoid further delays, but the split verdict allows the government to continue making appointments using current procedures.

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS2 Smart Cities Mission was a dream. That's the problem with our urban vision

The Smart Cities Mission (SCM) was India's largest political dream project in urban history, and its conclusion invites critical scrutiny of urban planning. Dream projects rely on state narratives of radical transformation and public relations rather than expert input, citizen experience, or rigorous feasibility. The SCM used an Area-Based Development (ABD) model that concentrated massive investments in tiny enclaves, reaching less than 10 per cent of the population in many cities.

[msn.com](#)

GS3 India can no longer overlook its pasture lands

Rangelands and permanent pastures serve as crucial common resources supporting livestock production, rural livelihoods, biodiversity, and ecological resilience across India. Despite their immense value, India lacks a dedicated national policy framework for rangelands and grasslands, leaving their management fragmented. The core issue is that rangelands are wrongly perceived as unproductive 'wastelands', leading to their diversion for agriculture and infrastructure. According to ICAR, India has about 11.5 million hectares of rangelands and permanent pastures producing around 28 million tonnes of forage annually.

[BusinessLine](#)

GS3 GST 2.0 revived demand. Now industry wants its tax credit unstuck

The GST Council is scheduled to meet after a one-year hiatus to take forward reforms initiated under GST 2.0. Rate compression under GST 2.0 reduced slabs to 5% and 18%, successfully rejuvenating aggregate economic demand and revenue collections. Surveys by KPMG and Deloitte highlighted the urgent need to remove legal, procedural, and administrative bottlenecks in the input tax credit scheme. Blockages in input tax credit flow cause cascading costs for businesses, placing domestic goods at a disadvantage against imports.

[Economic Times](#)

GS2 UPSC Editorial Analysis: Public Interest Litigation

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar termed Article 32 the heart and soul of the Constitution, forming with Article 226 the primary shield against state overreach. Post-Emergency, the Supreme Court relaxed locus standi rules, creating Public Interest Litigation and suo motu cognizance to empower marginalized citizens. Originally meant for bonded laborers and undertrials, these powers face criticism today for becoming selective, media-driven, and overburdened by policy matters.

[Insights on India](#)

GS2 Muthanga verdict: whose death counts?

The delivery of a 217-page judgment after 23 years of trial regarding Vinod's death brought the unequal handling of the Muthanga cases back into focus. An editorial critique highlighting the stark disparity in the judicial and investigative response to the deaths of Vinod and Jogi following the Muthanga incident. Twenty-three years produced a trial, 47 witnesses and a 217-page judgment for Vinod's death. For Jogi, they produced nothing — not a charge, a witness, or a line of inquiry.

[The Hindu](#)

GS2 Suspend SIR till the air is cleared

The Supreme Court is scheduled to hear a petition questioning Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's authority and decisions. An editorial discussing a Supreme Court plea that challenges the Chief Election Commissioner's authority and calls for pausing the SIR exercise. The petition questions whether the Election Commission acted collectively with its three-member panel. Reports indicate that two commissioners raised multiple objections regarding decisions made by the Election Commission.

[Economic Times](#)

GS2 GS3 Carbon credits need more than a nod

Britain recognised India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) as a qualifying carbon-pricing mechanism under its Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM), thus joining an established club of recognised carbon-pricing jurisdictions. The recognition, however, doesn't automatically strengthen India's efforts to achieve equivalence with existing or future carbon border adjustment mechanisms. However, it demonstrates the value of sustained technical engagement in addressing complex issues in a mutually beneficial manner.

[Economic Times](#)

GS3 RBI's wait and watch phase is over as inflation demands a rate hike

Retail inflation exceeding the 4 percent target alongside rising food and fuel prices has brought rate hike demands into focus. RBI has maintained its policy rate at 5.25% but is facing significant inflation pressures. Retail inflation has risen above the target of 4%, indicating the need for action. Food and fuel inflation are increasing, contributing to overall economic effects. Additionally, external factors, including global interest rates, add to the urgency for a rate hike.

[Economic Times](#)

GS3 Andy Mukherjee: If India wants to fuel the AI boom, it must get its solar power policies right

Rising global energy costs due to wars and New Delhi's push to court Big AI for domestic data centres have brought the need for stable solar policies into focus. The editorial argues that India must correct its erratic solar power policies if it wants to successfully power the artificial intelligence boom and attract Big AI data centres.

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS2 Deepening the India-US defence partnership

The 22nd edition of Yudh Abhyas 2026 brings roughly 500 American and 600 Indian soldiers together for annual bilateral training across India. The exercise aims to operationalize results-driven security partnerships that make both nations stronger and enhance capable partners' security. India conducts more military exercises with the United States than with any other nation, highlighting the depth of bilateral ties. Modernizing warfare integration features the first-time use of the US Army's Mobile Low, Slow, Small Unmanned Aircraft Integrated Defeat System (M-LIDS).

[Hindustan Times](#)

GS3 Navigating the US tariff threat — India's dual test on energy and exports

Growing concerns over potential US tariff actions and trade protectionism have brought India's economic exposure to external shocks into focus. The opinion piece discusses how India can reduce its economic vulnerability to US tariff threats through export diversification, new trade pacts, domestic manufacturing, and energy source diversification. Export diversification, new trade agreements, domestic manufacturing and diversification of energy sources could reduce the Indian economy's vulnerability to external trade shocks

[BusinessLine](#)

GS2 Election Commission and Court make it harder, not easier, to believe in independent institutions

The article criticises the Supreme Court and the Election Commission for acting in tandem with a disregard for constitutional purposes, inflicting administrative cruelty and disenfranchising citizens through the SIR enterprise. The author argues that the opaque SIR process, including software protocols, wrongfully shifted the burden of proof onto citizens, culminating in the Election Commission filing mass appeals against 16 lakh eligible voters in West Bengal.

[msn.com](#)

GS3 Inflection point for the Hydrogen Mission

India launched its Hydrogen Mission proactively to transition into a carbon-emission-free industrial economy and avert global warming disasters. The author argues that India has reached an inflection point where it can leapfrog into an advanced green industrial economy by the next decade. India holds a decisive cost advantage because solar power and storage prices in the country rank among the lowest globally. A recent SECI bid for green ammonia established a contract price of Rs. 53.3 per kg, which is comparable to imported urea.

[Hindustan Times](#)

GS2 What an infrastructure of innovation depends on: a responsive legal system

The Delhi High Court's specialized IP dispute model is praised as a framework, but other courts need equal investment to settle innovation disputes fast. India restored product patents for chemicals through the 2005 Patents Act amendment to comply with WTO TRIPS agreement rules. India maintained public interest guardrails like compulsory licences, checks on evergreening, a local working rule, and competition law curbs. Stronger rights multiplied IP types such as trademarks, copyrights, geographical indications, industrial designs, semiconductor layouts, and plant varieties, increasing disputes.

[civildaily.com](#)

GS3 A tiger is killed. A forest is destroyed. Then the case waits for years

India has strengthened wildlife laws and anti-poaching enforcement, but timely adjudication of forest and wildlife cases remains a critical missing link. Thousands of forest and wildlife cases remain pending in courts for years, causing witnesses to disperse, evidence to fade, and deterrence to weaken. The core issue is a lack of systematic implementation rather than a lack of recommendations, as various committees have urged fast-track courts for decades.

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS2 GS3 Surveillance is not the only privacy issue

Rajya Sabha member A.A. Rahim petitioned the Supreme Court against the Delhi Police using facial recognition and biometric surveillance during CJP protests. Diffuse surveillance involves watch shared among states, private companies and foreign vendors, creating a system where no single actor is answerable. State interest in identifying people predates Aadhaar by over 150 years, starting with British magistrate William Herschel taking handprints in 1858.

[The Hindu](#)

GS3 Best of BS Opinion: RBI's currency intervention must be limited

It was featured in the Business Standard opinion roundup addressing India's economic and institutional challenges. Opinions discuss the need to limit RBI's currency intervention alongside electoral roll revisions and distressed assets. From RBI intervention in the rupee and questions over electoral-roll revisions to distressed assets, India's growth challenges and political grief, today's opinions examine institutional and economic

[Business Standard](#)

GS3 Who is liable when AI gets it wrong? India's legal framework faces a test

A recent court ruling held that OpenAI's storage of ANI's work for training large language models is protected as fair dealing under Section 52(1)(a) of the Copyright Act. The court reasoned that training a model is a form of research for generating new knowledge, despite the legislature not anticipating AI when amending the Act in 2012. The finding that OpenAI's use is private has been criticized because the data is ultimately put to a commercial purpose rather than a non-paying, non-commercial one.

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS3 MSMEs and startups: converging for growth

The blurring lines between innovation, scale, and production have brought the synergy between MSMEs and startups into focus. The article discusses the need for convergence between India's startup ecosystem and traditional MSMEs to drive mutual growth and innovation. As the boundaries between innovation, scale and production blur, India needs an ecosystem that combines the strengths of startups and traditional businesses.

[Mint](#)

GS3 What's holding back private capital expenditure?**The weakness of India's unlisted corporate sector**

The discussion is triggered by data showing that while post-covid listed companies recovered, unlisted firms worsened and restricted overall investment. The article examines why private capital expenditure in India is held back, highlighting the poor financial health of the unlisted corporate sector compared to the listed sector. While the financial position of the listed sector has improved post covid, that of the unlisted sector has worsened. This has constrained overall corporate investment in the Indian economy, given the size of the latter.

[Mint](#)

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

AFSPA – Significance & Concerns The Ministry of Home Affairs extended the Armed Forces Special Powers Act for another six months from 1 October 2026 in specified areas of Manipur, Nagaland, and Arunachal Pradesh. The extension follows a review of the security situation in these North-eastern states where insurgency and internal security threats exist.

[ForumIAS](#)

What are the provisions of AFSPA? The Union Ministry of Home Affairs extended the Armed Forces Special Powers Act for another six months from October 1, 2026, in parts of Manipur, Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh. The extension responds to continuing security concerns and ethnic conflict starting May 3, 2023, which reversed earlier reductions of AFSPA-covered areas in Manipur.

[ForumIAS](#)

Casteist slurs on social media can attract SC/ST Act: What Calcutta HC said on 'public view' The ruling came into the news following the Calcutta High Court's interpretation of the SC/ST Act regarding digital offenses. The Calcutta High Court held that posting casteist slurs on social media platforms fulfills the requirement of being in a 'public view' and can attract the SC/ST Act.

[Indian Express](#)

What are the new guidelines set by IN-SPACe for Indian and foreign hosted-payloads IN-SPACe issued new guidelines for hosted payloads under the Indian Space Policy-2023 on September 17. The guidelines require mandatory authorisation for Indian payloads hosted on foreign satellites. Foreign payload owners are exempted from separate authorisation when hosted on Indian satellites.

[The Hindu](#)

Uttarakhand's first glacial lake early-warning system: What it will monitor, why it matters Uttarakhand launched an initiative to install its first glacial lake early warning system at Vasundhara Tal in Chamoli district. The fortnight-long expedition running until October 15 aims to monitor conditions that could signal a glacial lake outburst flood.

[newindianexpress.com](#)

Conundrum over demography panel's questionnaire seeking extensive data The release of the panel's detailed questionnaire targeting demographic shifts has brought the issue into public focus. An expert panel issued a comprehensive questionnaire seeking extensive data on demographic changes, sparking debates on scope and privacy.

[The Hindu](#)

Article 370 to statehood demand: J&K's evolving constitutional status Jammu and Kashmir Legislative Assembly passed a resolution during its Autumn Session, drawing sharp criticism from the Leader of Opposition Sunil Sharma. The BJP supports the restoration of statehood to Jammu and Kashmir but strongly opposes mixing it with references to pre-1953 positions, Article 370, and Article 35A.

[zeenews.india.com](#)

Railways' network is almost fully electrified. So why has it launched LNG train to cut emissions? The launch of LNG trains by Indian Railways to curb emissions despite high electrification levels has drawn public and expert attention. Indian Railways has introduced LNG-powered trains as part of its sustainability initiatives to cut down emissions, even as its broad network nears full electrification.

[Indian Express](#)

Experts Explain | What the UN sea level declaration means for the world The UN recently adopted a major declaration focusing on the crisis of rising sea levels. An explainer detailing the significance of the UN sea level declaration and its implications for global coastlines, including India.

[Indian Express](#)

How are fronts formed and classified? Explain the weather sequence associated with the passage of a mid-latitude frontal system. How does occlusion alter the evolution of the associated cyclone? Fronts are dynamic transition zones formed when two contrasting air masses meet, serving as the framework for mid-latitude weather systems. Frontogenesis is the basic mechanism of front formation, driven by the convergence of warm and cold air masses with different temperatures and densities.

[Insights on India](#)

What factors account for the relatively low insurance penetration in India? How can distribution reforms help address them?

India continues to experience relatively low insurance penetration and a wide protection gap across various demographics. Structural, economic, and behavioural factors are responsible for this low penetration rate. Key constraints include affordability issues, lack of awareness, and trust deficits among potential policyholders.

[Insights on India](#)

CISF jawan kills colleagues: Inside the high-stress life of paramilitary forces A fatal shooting incident involving a CISF jawan and his colleagues put the spotlight on paramilitary stress. An incident where a CISF jawan killed colleagues has brought attention to the high-stress conditions and mental health challenges within Indian paramilitary forces.

[Indian Express](#)

U.S troops leave Iraq: How a 23 year military presence unfolded The complete withdrawal of U.S troops from Iraq brings the 23-year military deployment into focus. U.S troops have concluded their military presence in Iraq after 23 years, marking the end of a prolonged chapter of American intervention that started in 2003.

[The Hindu](#)

What do you understand by administrative paternalism? Under what circumstances can paternalistic decision-making undermine the autonomy and dignity of citizens? Administrative paternalism refers to welfare-oriented state interventions where authorities make decisions on behalf of citizens to protect them from harm. The core ethical dilemma involves balancing the state's duty of care or beneficence with the citizen's right to autonomy and self-determination.

[Insights on India](#)

Why is Konaseema still waiting for its railway line, 26 years on? Campaigners in Amalapuram are now planning a people's movement and a bandh because most bridge pillars are built but the line remains incomplete. The Kotipalli-Narsapur railway line project in Konaseema remains stalled 26 years after its inception due to issues regarding state land and cost-sharing.

[The Hindu](#)

AI Is Creating A Divide Among Employees, PwC Survey Finds; Where Do Indian Workers Stand? The release of the new PwC survey findings on AI adoption and workforce division put the topic in the news. A PwC survey reveals that artificial intelligence is creating a technological and skill divide among employees, highlighting how Indian workers stand on adoption.

[News18](#)

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- India's emerging quantum ecosystem strengthened by enabling policy of the Modi government: Dr Jitendra Singh (Science & Technology) [PIB](#)
- UPSC Centenary Celebrations 'Manthan' Focus on Future-Ready Civil Services, Innovation and Constitutional Values (Polity & Constitution) [PIB](#)
- Kerala HC seeks report from State on socio-economic survey of other backward classes (Social Justice & Welfare) [The Hindu](#)
- US Trade Representative Greer jokes Piyush Goyal is 'trade minister for life' as G20 trade talks open in Milwaukee (International Relations) [Economic Times](#)
- India eyes rebalanced ASEAN trade pact in ongoing review (International Relations) [BusinessLine](#)
- Irregularities in land conversion, encroachment in Odisha tehsils: CAG report (Governance & Policy) [Hindustan Times](#)
- Rs. 1,600 Crore Approved for 41 Pharma & MedTech Innovation Projects under PRIP First Round (Science & Technology) [PIB](#)
- Meaning of Reduction in Import Duty on Edible Oils in India (Economy) [ForumIAS](#)
- India's external debt rises to \$778.2 billion in June quarter, RBI data shows (Economy) [BusinessLine](#)
- EPFO launches six-month amnesty scheme for exempted provident fund trusts (Economy) [DD News](#)
- Modi, Trump review bilateral ties days after US enacts Russia and Iran sanctions law (International Relations) [The New Indian Express](#)
- Concerned citizens urge CJI to uphold liberty of Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam (Polity & Constitution) [The Hindu](#)
- 21 States, UTs Sign MoUs With Civil Aviation Ministry For Next Phase Of UDAN (Infrastructure & Energy) [The Right News](#)
- Centre approves Rs 2,117.85 crore SDRF assistance for flood-hit states (Disaster Management) [DD News](#)
- India's fighter jet engine efforts get a big boost: Desi Kaveri engine clears key step in Russia, ready for integration with stealth UCAV 'Ghatak' (Defence) [Economic Times](#)
- Haryana Launches Patent Support, Commercialisation and Innovation Facilitation Policy 2026-27 (Governance & Policy) [Drishti IAS](#)
- 'Preventive detention not punitive': Supreme Court states in Sambhal mosque violence National Security Act case (Polity & Constitution) [Hindustan Times](#)
- India, Qatar agree to accelerate BIT and FTA engagement (International Relations) [BusinessLine](#)

- Scientists map earliest glow of hydrogen, opening a new window to the universe (Science & Technology) [PIB](#)
- Corporate Laws Bill: JPC seeks 25% ceiling on buybacks as Centre reworks rules (Economy) [cfo.economicstimes.indiatimes.com](#)
- SRM-A.P. features in THE World University Rankings 2027 (Education) [The Hindu](#)
- Judges should not impose personal views on morality in bail cases or criminal trials: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) [Bar & Bench](#)
- From Tsunami Relief to Strategic Partnership: How the Quad Has Evolved (International Relations) [DD News](#)
- INDIA bloc to launch nationwide campaign against CEC, SIR from October 2 (Polity & Constitution) [The Hindu](#)
- Russia warns NATO of a possible nuclear response if Kaliningrad is cut off (International Relations) [Hindustan Times](#)
- India to have more elderly people later this century as fertility falls, age structure shifts: Moody's (Social Justice & Welfare) [The Hindu](#)
- DRDO successfully flight-tests Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket with 60-km minimum range (Defence) [DD News](#)
- Iran retaliates after Israeli strikes its nuclear program; 3 killed, several wounded (International Relations) [The Hindu](#)
- India Ranks 38th In Global Innovation Index 2026, Tops South Asia (Economy) [ETV Bharat](#)
- 'Court must protect liberty of accused if trial may be delayed', says Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) [Times of India](#)
- 'Save democracy' marches, moving SC against 2023 Act: INDIA bloc readies plan over CEC row (Polity & Constitution) [Indian Express](#)
- Police Station CCTV Not Working? Allahabad High Court Lays Down Safeguards For Persons Arrested, Brought... (Polity & Constitution) [LiveLaw](#)
- Press Releases| Official Website of Reserve Bank of India (Economy) [rbi.org.in](#)
- 526 kg drugs worth Rs 3,000 crore seized from Iranian boat with Pakistani crew (Internal Security) [Times of India](#)
- Paras Defence unit signs MoU for Rs. 6,200 Cr semiconductor facility (Economy) [scanx.trade](#)

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 16 must-know, 17 Prelims facts, 35 in the news, 22 editorials, 16 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (7), Agriculture & Allied (5), Economy (5), Environment & Ecology (5), International Relations (4), Infrastructure & Energy (2), Governance & Policy (2), Science & Technology (1), Health (1), History, Art & Culture (1).

Nothing today in — Social Justice & Welfare, Education, Internal Security, Defence, Disaster Management, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 5 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: nothing today · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 2 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 46 of 71 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — PIB 12, The Hindu 9, Economic Times 5, Hindustan Times 4, Insights on India 4, Deccan Herald 4, Indian Express 4, ForumIAS 3, Mint 3, ddnews.gov.in 2, Business Standard 2, msn.com 2, BusinessLine 2, Vajiram & Ravi 1

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